

Clayton Freshcorn, RHP, Texas A&M

2026 Stats: 2.82 ERA/1.049 WHIP/54.1 IP/56 K/6 BB/9.33 K:BB

6-0, 180

Metrics

FB: 93.2/15.6 IVB/10.1 HB/-4.03 VAA/5.3relH/6.4 ext/31.4 AA/47.7% zone/49.3% usage/2210 rpm

SI: 92.5/8.7 IVB/16.1 HB/-5.46 VAA/22.7 AA/50% zone/2.3% usage/2110 rpm

SL: 85.9/5.5 IVB/-3.8 HB/-6.26 VAA/23.1 AA/43.4% zone/29.1% usage/2420 rpm

SWP: 82.1/4.3/-14.9 HB/-6.79 VAA/17.8 AA/33% zone/12% usage/2440 rpm

CH: 84.7/4.6 IVB/8.6 HB/-6.75 VAA/25.7 AA/26.3% zone/7.3% usage/1200 rpm

Write-up

The dog in an Aggies pitching staff that was often starved for high quality innings, Freshcorn racked up 12 saves across 54 innings with elite strikeout to walk numbers and impressive stuff. While a college reliever, the arsenal and total workload suggest that he could become a starter long term. The breakers are plus present while the fastball exhibits traits that give Freshcorn a solid foundation as he translates his skills into the Cardinals organization. While the stuff and raw traits may never make Freshcorn a true ace, the floor with 2 plus breaking balls is a solid reliever assuming the command he showcased holds.

The FB was simply elite in 2026, allowing a .187 avg and 0 home runs in the SEC gauntlet. The pitch has below average raw ride and velo, but the low release point and above average extension create plus carry through the top of the zone. When elevated, he got a 25% whiff rate on the season, showing how true that carry is. The 74% strike rate was in the 100th percentile of NCAA pitchers in 2026 as well.

He was able to throw up with consistency and was often away from either handedness. The exceptional command and upshoot shape give Freshcorn a FB that is a solid foundation. 45/50 pitch

The SI was used rarely and is a pure ASR pitch. The pitch will need to be developed long term for Freshcorn to pan out as a starter. It is projectable as it gets plus ASR and it was in the zone 50% of the time. 35/45 pitch

The SL, called a cutter by the Aggies staff, is the best pitch in the arsenal with hard and late lateral movement and plus velo. It would currently be an average big league slider in shape, but the spotting leaves something to be improved on. He left a lot of sliders up in the zone to righties who hit .297 on the pitch this past year. It got whiffs when he got the SL D/A but too many elevated misses hurt the value this season. To lefties, the spots were just as suboptimal, with a lot of backdoor SLs leaking over the middle. He also didn't showcase the ability to back foot often which is a big plus when executed well. 50/55 pitch

The SWP is a very lateral pitch with late glove side and it holds its height well. He showcased better feel at getting glove side than the SL and the results corroborate that with a 42% whiff and 20% SWSTR, both double plus numbers. It has clear separation from the slider as well which is important as Freshcorn packs on velo and tightens up breaks. 50/55 pitch

The CH is a fader without much ASR that struggled to get results and did not clip the bottom of the zone enough to get chases from lefties. The 20% chase rate to lefties was squarely subpar and the lack of bite forces the shape downwards. Working the current CH into a split or ASR change will help deal with lefties long term. 35/40 pitch